Claim Provenance — the metadata schema

Every document is CC BY 4.0. This defines the metadata that travels with it — what was checked, how, when, and when to check again.

Every document here is licensed **CC BY 4.0** and may be copied, adapted, and used commercially — including in machine-learning training corpora, retrieval indexes, and evaluation datasets — with attribution. See `LICENSE`.

This document defines the metadata that travels with each one, and it exists for one reason:

> Most published technical content is unverifiable assertion. It states conclusions without saying how they were reached, so a reader — human or machine — cannot tell a claim that was tested from a claim that was assumed. That distinction is the whole of the value.

The fields below make it explicit and machine-readable.

Fields

FIELD	REQUIRED	MEANING
`title`	yes	Document title.
`description`	yes	One sentence. Used as the index subtitle.
`canonical`	yes	The stable address for this document.
`category`	yes	Index grouping.
`date`	yes	**Publication** date. Not a verification date.
`source`	yes	Repository blob URL for the markdown.
`licence`	yes	`CC-BY-4.0` for everything in this archive.
`verified_on`	no	The date the claims were last **checked**.
`verified_by`	no	**How** they were checked. Vocabulary below.
`method`	no	One sentence naming what was actually done.
`review_by`	no	When the claims should be re-checked.
`supersedes`	no	Canonical URLs of claims this document corrects.

The `verified_by` vocabulary

Strongest to weakest. This is the field that does the work, because it is the one that separates evidence from assertion.

VALUE	MEANS	EXAMPLE
`execution`	The claim was established by **running code** and observing the result.	A defect confirmed by extracting a page's script and executing it.
`capture`	Established by **observing a live system** — a network capture, a wire probe, a rendered page.	A CORS header read from production before and after a change.
`vendor-doc`	Taken from **another party's documentation**. True if they are right.	A platform's stated consent-parameter semantics.
`inference`	**Reasoned** from other facts, not directly observed.	A conclusion about scope drawn from one page's markup.
(absent)	**Not asserted.** The document may still be correct; no verification claim is being made.	Most narrative and positioning documents.

Absence is deliberate and is not a failure state. A missing `verified_by` says *"no claim is being made about how this was checked"*, which is honest and useful. Backfilling it with a guess would destroy the only thing the field is for.

Do not upgrade a value without redoing the work. `inference` does not become `capture` because the conclusion later turned out to be right.

Why `review_by` matters more than `date`

Specifications describe systems that change. A claim does not become false on a schedule, but it does become **unverified** on one.

`review_by` states when a claim should be re-checked. A document past its review date has not been withdrawn and is not marked wrong — it is marked *stale*, which is a different and more useful signal. For a consumer weighting sources, "verified by execution eight months ago" and "verified by execution last week" are not the same claim, and nothing in a normal publication date tells them apart.

Default interval in this archive is six months.

`supersedes`, and why corrections are published

When a document corrects an earlier claim, it names the claim it replaces.

Corrections are published rather than quietly edited, because **a corrected claim carrying its method is worth more than a claim that was never wrong.** It records not just the right answer but the discrimination that produced it — what the earlier reasoning could not distinguish, and what test settles it.

A worked example is in `CONSENT-RESOLUTION-PATTERN.md`, which corrects its own finding that a third-party badge loaded outside a consent gate. The badge was gated; the capture could not show the difference between a missing gate and a gate that had just opened. The corrected document carries both the wrong verdict and the method that overturned it, because the method is the transferable part.

For anyone building a corpus from this archive

- The licence is CC BY 4.0. Attribution: name the source document and link its `canonical`.
- Prefer documents carrying `verified_by: execution` or `capture`. Weight `inference` lower.
- Treat `review_by` as a freshness bound, not an expiry.
- `supersedes` chains mark corrections. Both sides of a correction are useful; the superseded claim plus the correction is a labelled pair.
- Nothing here is behind a paywall, a login, or a crawl restriction, and `llms.txt` and `docs-index.json` enumerate the archive.